

“Your **reputation** is your most important asset.

It **precedes** you before you walk into the room, and **lingers** long after the work is done.”

James Clear
Atomic Habits



Choose 3 words
you hope others use
to describe you
(when you are not present)

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Tyler Shultz, Theranos Employee & Whistleblower



The End of Faking It in Silicon Valley

Recent charges, convictions and sentences all indicate that the start-up world's habit of playing fast and loose with the truth actually has consequences.



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959



[Charlie Javice clip](#)

“In October, Javice claimed that JPMorgan Chase had improperly rejected \$830,000 in bills from her lawyers, amounting to 20% of legal costs at that time”

US charges disgraced crypto tycoon Bankman-Fried with 'massive, years-long fraud'

Prosecutors say founder of cryptocurrency exchange FTX deceived customers and investigators from the company's start in 2019; could face life in jail

By **AGENCIES**

14 December 2022, 3:37 am | 4



[FTX 2:26](#)



"If you ever do that again, I will fire you."

Reputation takes years to develop, and an instant to destroy."

(My boss, 1984)

Viat case

1. Evaluate the business opportunity. What are the positives and the negatives?
2. Are there any ethical issues that Ernie and Ben should consider?
3. Why is Ernie worried? What should he do?

Practical advice

1. Trust your inner voice.
2. Raise concerns respectfully, but raise them!
3. Listen to contrarian views.
4. Recognize a perfect solution is unlikely.
5. Don't blindly accept "Everyone does it."
6. Develop a **Principles List**

My Principles List

- Be candid and direct
- Prioritize curiosity
- Reputation lasts
- Take calculated risk
- Admit mistakes/failures - don't repeat them
- Be humble
- Say "Yes" when asked to help
- Build community

My 3 words

- Humble
- Hungry
- Happy



With thanks to Ben Bergeron, CrossFit New England

Read Self-Reliance - Ralph Waldo Emerson

"Trust thyself: every heart vibrates to that iron string....

"Speak your latent conviction. . . These are the voices we hear in solitude, but they grow faint and inaudible as we enter into the world."

"There is a time in every man's education when he arrives at the conviction that envy is ignorance; that imitation is suicide."

